Salam Pacasum Naga-Pangadapun

Bae Salam Pacasum Naga-Pangadapun (also known as Salam Naga Pangadapun, or by her Hajj name Norhayah; affectionately called "**Ate Salam**") was a Maranao political figure and traditional leader who served as mayor of Marawi City, Lanao del Sur, from 1985 to 1986. She holds the distinction of being the first woman to occupy that office. Her short tenure came at a turbulent moment in Philippine history, bridging the final period of the Marcos administration and the early months after the 1986 People Power Revolution.

Contents

1 Early Life and Family
2 Education
3 Career and Public Service
4 Leadership Roles and Cultural Contributions
5 Personal Life and Children
6 Legacy and Historical Significance

Early Life and Family

She was born on December 12, 1945, into a prominent Maranao political and traditional family. She was the only child of **Sultan Cosain Naga** (also referred to as Sheik Cosain Naga), who served as *appointed mayor of Marawi City from 1954 to 1957*, and **Bae Saripa Ali Pacasum** (also known as Hadja Saripa Ali Pacasum-Naga).

Her maternal grandparents are identified in available family accounts as **Sheik Abdul Rahman Pacasum** and **Baialabi a Gaos Pala Ali**. She later married the late **Judge Yusoph Pangadapun** of the Regional Trial Court in Marawi City (Branch 10). He is now deceased. The marriage linked a traditional political lineage with the local judiciary.

Education

According to the primary reference document, she studied at the **Philippine Women's University** in Manila. She earned a **Bachelor of Arts in Psychology** and later a **master's degree in public administration** from the same institution. Independent public records confirming the exact degrees and years of attendance were not located in available official or institutional sources during this research.

Career and Public Service

Bae Salam entered local government service in Marawi City during a period of significant political change in the Philippines. She assumed the position of **mayor in 1985** and held office through 1986, becoming the **first woman to serve as the city's chief executive.**

Her time in office coincided with the final months of the Marcos administration and the early days of the new national leadership that followed the [illegible]on. As part of the broader reorganization of local governments [illegible]fficers-in-Charge were appointed across the country, and she stepped down [illegible]n.

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Despite the relatively short duration of her term, her service marked a notable moment in the city's political history as the first instance of a woman holding the top municipal post in a setting long shaped by traditional male leadership.

Leadership Roles and Cultural Contributions

Beyond formal office, family and local accounts describe her as active in traditional Maranao conflict resolution, particularly ***kapamasad sa rido*** (the mediation and settlement of blood feuds). Rido refers to inter-family conflicts that can persist across generations and involve land, honor, or political disputes. Mediation of this kind draws on traditional authority, Islamic principles, and interpersonal skill. Independent contemporary documentation of specific cases she mediated was not located in publicly available primary sources, though the practice itself is well-attested in Maranao culture.

Personal Life and Children

She and Judge Yusoph Pangadapun had several children who have continued in public service in Marawi City and the broader Bangsamoro region:

- **Rawia N. Pangadapun** has served as City Civil Registrar of Marawi City.
- **Yasmira Pangadapun-Muti** (also referred to as Bai Yasmira Pangadapun) has held the position of Provincial Social Welfare Officer under the Ministry of Social Services and Development / DSWD-BARMM.
- **Yusoph "Popoy" Pangadapun** served as vice mayor of Marawi City (listed in some records for the period around 1998–2004).
- **Yanisah Pangadapun-Lanto** has been active at the barangay level; Norhaya Village in Marawi is named in connection with her mother's Hajj name and appears in official barangay listings.

Legacy and Historical Significance

Her principal historical marker is her status as **Marawi's first female mayor.** In a region where traditional and formal politics have long been male dominated, her assumption of the office, even for a limited period resulting from an election protest and succession, represented a break with precedent. The family's continued presence in local civil registration, social welfare administration, the city legislature, and barangay leadership illustrate intergenerational continuity common in Philippine local politics, particularly in Lanao del Sur.

- Base reference provided by **Bang Pacasum** (https://www.facebook.com/pacasum)

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